Level Design Brief Template

Level Name:
(Provide a clear working name for the level.)

Brief

Overview of the level.

Setting: Where is the level and what does it look like?

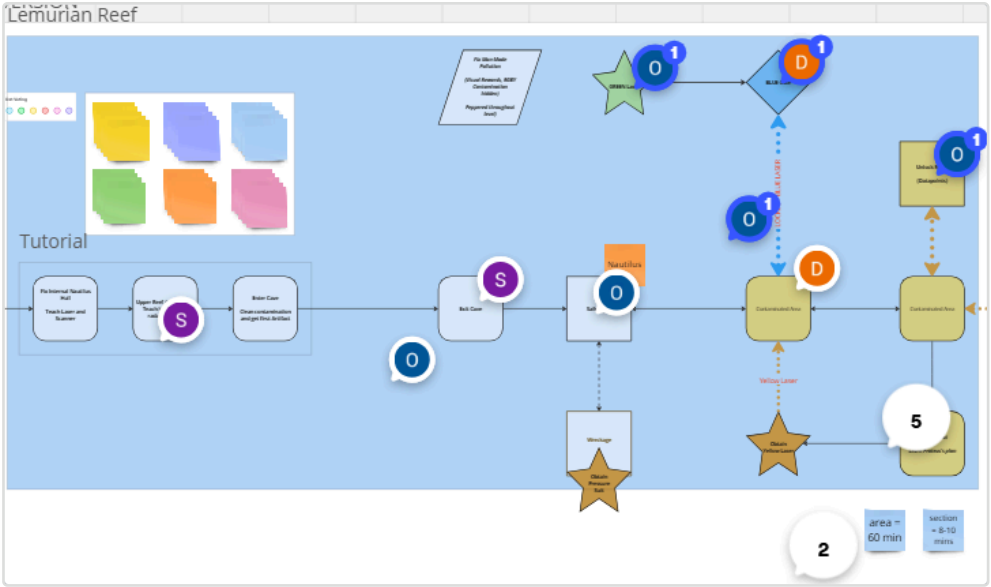
Player Mood: What should the player feel as they go through the level?

Level Purpose: What's its role in the game and what are the new challenges? What's its core gameplay?

Progression: How does this level impact the overall progression? What does it unlock for the player?

Narrative: How does it fit into the story?

First Pass Level Design



Provide a linear progression wireframe of the level beats

Level Progression Wireframe / Intended Progression

Provide a conceptual diagram that shows the beats of the level on their ideal path.
It does not have to be artful.
This should create parity between both narrative and gameplay beats of the level.

What does the player do?
What are the narrative beats?
Where are the puzzles and hazards?
What does the player need to collect?

Level Diagram

A map of the level layout or a cross section is ideal.

Designate:

- Starting point
  - End Point, if different from start.
- Paths
  - Any branches
- Narrative beats
  - Events, encounters, dialogue if known
- Landmarks
  - Any Special assets
- Contamination
  - Datapoints for volumes, if relevant.
- Enemies
  - Enemy paths
- Obstacles
  - Paths, if moving
- Pickups / Artifacts

Level Beat Write-up

A quick walkthrough of the level, point form, outlining what happens moment-to-moment.
Focus on gameplay , not the in-depth story, though you can mention the intended events as well as user experience and emotions the player might feel. Give art a mental picture of what is going to happen.

- **Points of Interest**:
  (e.g., hidden rooms, unique environmental features, areas with clues)
- **Critical Areas for Progression**:
  (e.g., interactable objects, key doors or gates, puzzles etc)
- **Enemy or Hazard Spawn Points**:
  (Where are enemies or hazards located and do they move?)
- **The vibe of the beats themselves.**
  (Is the player excited or calm? Where are they looking? What is the action?)

Second Pass Level Design

Graphic Layout / Graybox Overview

Show the path through the level and clearly indicate contamination, events etc. Use your wireframe events here and include a legend.

Using a screenshot of the graybox itself, outline the intended path and beats.
This is most easily done on miro by taking your previously completed wireframe and copying it, overlaying it on a screenshot.

- What is the operation radius of the player?
  - Starting level versus middling level?
    - What is the farthest point to which they can travel and still get back to start?
- What's the intended order / pathway through the level?
  - Where are the obstacles?
  - Where are the puzzles?
  - Where are the enemies and their paths?
- How many contamination clusters are there?
  - How many datapoints do I get at 100%?
- How many artifacts are there?
- What upgrades are needed to complete the level, and when?
  - How many datapoints do I need?

Final Flow

This section won't necessarily exist, but after the main design and graybox are complete a revision pass on the progress wireframe should be made to ensure parity.

What is the ideal end to end sequence of this level?

Other

Any additional visual diagrams you've created that help explain the layout. These can be wireframes, flowcharts, or images. Anything needed to explain concepts not covered in the template.

Assets

Hyperlinked Feature List

List all features required for this level, but *especially* any new features.
Include links to feature pages for new hazards or mechanics, as these are not to be explained in detail here.
Example:

- Contamination Slalom Movement Puzzle(link to contamination slalom page)
  - Contamination Feature
  - Contamination Volume Feature

- Pressure Volume (link to pressure volume functionality)
- Pressure Puzzle Maze(link to pressure maze functionality page)
- Statue Puzzle (link to statue puzzle functionality page)

These pages should be children of the first level that uses them until further notice.

Concepts

Include concept art or early designs for the level. These can be environmental, enemy designs, or any visual style references needed to help visualize the level's mood.

Gameplay Elements

Challenges

What will be the obstacles and difficulties the player faces in this level?
This should be a hyperlinked list, no features are to be explained here.

- **Environmental Hazards**:
  - (e.g. underwater currents, toxic gas, traps)
- **Enemies**: Which enemies will they encounter?
  - (e.g. shark, behemoth, etv)
- **Puzzles/Tasks**: What kind of puzzles or tasks will the player face?
  - (e.g. cleanup, statue puzzle, etc)
- **Resource Management**: Any specific elements or strategy?
  - Special considerations for energy? Upgrades? Datapoint acquisition?

Key Interactions

Are there any new interactions? List and hylerpink them here.

- **Interacting with Objects**: Are there any special interactions with assets?
  - (e.g., pressing buttons, unlocking doors, activating something)
- **Using Tools**: What is the highest level upgrade the player should have?
  - (e.g., Sonic Laser, thrusters, grappling,Using the scanner for data points, contamination, etc.)
- **Collecting Items**: What progression or gameplay items are collected in the level?
  - (e.g., artifacts, energy crystals)

Visuals & Audio

What are the new and important visual and audio elements for this level?

Any specific aesthetic or mood we want to create at any specific beat?

- **Visual Elements**:
  (Describe the visual feel—lighting, environmental features, colors, or special visual effects that set the tone.)
- **Audio Feedback**:
  (What sounds are important here? Consider the atmosphere, interactions, and key moments.)

Completion Criteria

- **End State**:
  What's end condition for this level?
  - What is the minimum to complete versus 100%?
- **Player Progress**:
  What rewards did the player get for completing this level?
  - What abilities or items are needed to progress to the next level?
  - Consider linking this to the NEXT level page, this section will need to be compared to the requirements of the subsequent level.

Additional References

Any design references that didn't fit elsewhere.
Timestamped videos are preferred. Please describe what the team should specifically be looking at.